

**This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.**

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Ceftriaxone 1g powder for injection for the treatment of Gonorrhoea Treatment

## Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Gonorrhoea Treatment

### Overview

Gonorrhoea is caused by *Neisseria gonorrhoeae* and is the second most common bacterial sexually transmitted infection in the UK. Single-dose intramuscular ceftriaxone is the first-line treatment for uncomplicated genital, rectal, and pharyngeal gonorrhoea.

### Assessment

- **Diagnostic testing:** Nucleic acid amplification test (NAAT) from urethral, rectal, pharyngeal, or vaginal specimens as appropriate
- **Sexual history:** Document recent sexual contacts and symptoms
- **Symptoms:** Urethral/vaginal discharge, dysuria, rectal or pharyngeal symptoms, asymptomatic patients on screening
- **Partner notification:** Essential; contacts within 2 weeks should be tested and treated
- **Concurrent infections:** Screen for syphilis and HIV; test for chlamydia (often concurrent)

### Management

- **First-line treatment:** Ceftriaxone 1g IM as single dose
- **Test of cure:** NAAT at 2 weeks post-treatment (not earlier, as residual nucleic acid may give false positive)
- **Partner treatment:** Contacts should be offered treatment (typically with same regimen)

### Red flags

- Disseminated gonococcal infection (DGI) with arthritis or dermatitis
- Pelvic inflammatory disease (PID) or epididymo-orchitis
- Meningitis or endocarditis features
- Concurrent syphilis or HIV
- Anaphylaxis or severe hypersensitivity reaction

### Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

**Ceftriaxone 1g powder for injection**

for the treatment of

**Gonorrhoea Treatment**

## Healthcare professionals covered and training

|                                              | Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Qualifications and Registration</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> <li>• Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Training and assessment</b>               | <p>Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines</li> <li>• All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication</li> <li>• Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer</li> <li>• All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service</li> </ul> |
| <b>Further training and responsibilities</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal</li> <li>• All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products</li> <li>• All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

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|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>PGD Indication</b>     | Treatment of uncomplicated genital, rectal, or pharyngeal gonorrhoea caused by <i>Neisseria gonorrhoeae</i> in adults.                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Inclusion criteria</b> | <p>Adults aged 18 years or over</p> <p>Positive NAAT for <i>N. gonorrhoeae</i> OR strong clinical suspicion with clear epidemiological link</p> <p>Uncomplicated genital, rectal, or pharyngeal infection</p> <p>Capacity to provide informed consent</p> <p>Able to attend test of cure appointment at 2 weeks</p> |
| <b>Exclusion criteria</b> | <p>Known anaphylaxis or severe hypersensitivity to cephalosporins</p> <p>Severe penicillin allergy (anaphylaxis; cross-reactivity ~1-2%)</p> <p>Complicated gonococcal infection (disseminated DGI, meningitis, endocarditis) - requires hospital treatment</p> <p>Concomitant meningitis or endocarditis</p>       |
| <b>Cautions</b>           | <p>Mild/moderate penicillin allergy: Risk of cross-reactivity is low (~1-2%); clinical assessment required</p> <p>Renal impairment: Standard dose suitable for eGFR &gt;30; no dose adjustment needed for mild-moderate impairment</p>                                                                              |

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|                                                             | <p>Hepatic impairment: Standard dose acceptable; monitor in severe impairment</p> <p>Anticoagulant therapy: Cephalosporins may potentiate warfarin effect; monitor INR</p> <p>Pregnancy: Ceftriaxone is safe in pregnancy; complicated cases should be referred to obstetrics</p> <p>Probenecid: May increase ceftriaxone levels; avoid concurrent use</p> |
| <b>Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment</b> | <p>Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed.</p> <p>Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.</p>                                                                                                                                                                         |

### ***Details of the medicine***

|                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name, form and strength of medicine</b>         | Ceftriaxone 1g powder for reconstitution for injection                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Legal category</b>                              | POM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Storage</b>                                     | Store reconstituted solution below 25°C. Reconstitute immediately before use with 3.5mL of 1% lidocaine solution for injection.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Route/method of administration</b>              | Intramuscular injection into gluteal muscle                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Dose and frequency</b>                          | <p>1g as a single intramuscular dose</p> <p>Reconstitute 1g vial with 3.5mL of 1% lidocaine solution for injection</p> <p>Administer as single IM injection into gluteal muscle</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Quantity to be administered and/or supplied</b> | Single dose treatment (1 vial of 1g powder)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Maximum or minimum treatment period</b>         | Single administration. Test of cure at 2 weeks. Partner notification essential.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Adverse effects</b>                             | <p>Common (<math>\geq 1/100</math>): Injection site pain/induration, diarrhoea</p> <p>Uncommon (<math>\geq 1/1000</math>): Nausea, rash, headache, dizziness, eosinophilia, elevated liver enzymes, candidiasis</p> <p>Rare (<math>\geq 1/10,000</math>): Anaphylaxis, pseudomembranous colitis, blood dyscrasias (thrombocytopenia, agranulocytosis), gallbladder sludging, Jarisch-Herxheimer reaction</p> |

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| <b>Yellow card reporting</b> | Report suspected adverse effects via <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> and inform the GP as appropriate. |
| <b>Records to be kept</b>    | <p>Record the following information:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>that valid informed consent was given</li> </ul>                   |

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|  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• name of individual, address, date of birth and GP</li> <li>• name of healthcare practitioner</li> <li>• name and brand of medication</li> <li>• date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied</li> <li>• advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment</li> <li>• details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD</li> </ul> <p>Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made.</p> <p>A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years</li> <li>• Children aged under 18 years - keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)</li> </ul> |
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### **Patient information**

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| <b>Written information to be given to patient or carer</b> | Provide written information on gonorrhoea treatment, the single injection, expected side effects, and importance of attending test of cure appointment. Advise on partner notification and safe sex practices.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer</b>    | <p>You have received a single injection of ceftriaxone to treat gonorrhoea</p> <p>Mild pain and swelling at the injection site is normal and usually resolves within 24-48 hours</p> <p>Avoid sexual contact until you and your partner(s) have completed treatment</p> <p>It is essential that your recent sexual partners are tested and treated (contacts within 2 weeks should be offered treatment)</p> <p>Attend your test of cure appointment at 2 weeks - this confirms that treatment has worked</p> <p>If you develop symptoms of other sexually transmitted infections (discharge, dysuria, pelvic pain), seek medical advice</p> <p>Use condoms during sexual contact to prevent transmission of gonorrhoea and other STIs</p> <p>If you experience allergic reactions (severe rash, swelling, breathing difficulty), seek immediate medical attention</p> <p>If you develop severe diarrhoea or abdominal pain after treatment, seek medical advice (pseudomembranous colitis risk)</p> <p>Avoid alcohol if you experience gastrointestinal side effects</p> |

### **Key references**

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017  
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017  
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance: Sexually Transmitted Infections: Gonorrhoea
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines

### Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------------|-----------|
| Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates |             |                     |           |
|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
| Name of healthcare professional                                                   | Job title   | Registration number | Signature |
|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
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|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
| Valid from date                                                                   | Expiry date |                     |           |
| 1/11/25                                                                           | 31/10/26    |                     |           |

### PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

|                                        |                                  |           |      |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|
| Name of superintendent / clinical lead | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|                                        |                                  |           |      |
| Name of professional group signatory   | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|                                        |                                  |           |      |

**Signed on behalf of Get Real Health**

| Name             | Qualification                  | Signature                                                                          | Date    |
|------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Nitin Shori      | Medical Doctor<br>GMC: 6047293 |   | 2/11/25 |
| Chris Pilkington | Pharmacist<br>GPhC: 2046322    |  | 2/11/25 |

**Change history**

| Version number | Change details                 | Date              |
|----------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|
| 001            | Development & issue of new PGD | 1st November 2025 |
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